

Not the way

Dell insists that it won't follow HP in attempting to sell PC business

Cell Phone Test



Dell XCD 35

best of both worlds - the touchscreen plus physical QWERTY phones. The Samsung Galaxy Pro has a pretty uniform design, Blackberry-ish as some say. The phone fits well in the hand; with a 2.8-inch touchscreen and keypad. It feels quite plasticky though. The second phone that falls in the same category is the Sony Ericsson Xperia X10 Mini Pro. This one is by far the smallest in this bunch, helped by the slide-out keypad. The size makes it very comfortable to use just as a touchscreen phone or even with the keypad. The updated design is much better than the one it replaces, and the build quality sees a massive improvement as well. The rubberised finish on the battery cover helps with the grip. It has by far the best build of all the touch + QWERTY phones in this range. The keypad seems to be a compressed version of the one we saw on the Nokia N97



Motorola Flipout

a long time back but it's softer on key response. The flat keys could have done with a slight bulge though.

The Motorola Flipout has the most unique design among the lot. The QWERTY swivels out on its axis—with the jury still out on how comfortable it is to use. The Motorola Charm has a traditional design, also seen on the Galaxy Pro. However, the Charm feels bigger than it actually is. The keys have a profound bulge on them, which makes typing on them an immensely comfortable experience.

Onto the touchscreen only phones now. Among a bunch of run-of-the mill designs—the likes of the Dell XCD35, Samsung Galaxy Fit, LG Optimus One, Motorola Quench XT502



Samsung Galaxy Fit S5670

and the Acer Liquid Mini—the slightest variation in design would stand out, and so it does, for the Sony Ericsson Xperia Mini. The 3-inch display ensures that it's the smallest phone of the bunch. The updated design on the new Mini and materials used mean that this one is comparatively superior to hold and use than its predecessor.

As a matter of fact, the Mini feels better than most of the phones in this category. While most of the phones feel as expensive as they are, the

Xperia Mini is built to feel a lot more expensive than it actually is. The goodness doesn't end there, Samsung's TouchWiz, Motorola's MotoBlur and even LG's UI aren't as good looking as the TimeScape UI on the Xperia Mini siblings.

Performance: With most of these phones there exist the limitations of the display, with regards to resolution and colour. However, the two Sony Ericsson siblings and the Dell XCD35 stand out with considerably better displays. All phones are on a relatively similar playing field in terms of call clarity across all 3-signal zones. What's impressive is that the that two Sony Ericsson phones perform best when the signal strength on your phone is at 25 per cent or less. While the rest of the cameras are on a similar level, the Dell XCD35 and the Motorola Flipout have by far the worst clickers out there. Surprisingly, the Motorola Quench XT502's camera is the best among them all.

And the winner is: Given that this category only had Android phones, the winner would need to do really well in terms of features and performance. The Sony Ericsson Xperia Mini, with a market price of



Sony Ericsson Xperia Mini



BlackBerry Curve 3G

₹10,000, is our Best Buy pick in this category. It comes with Android 2.3 preloaded, which no other phone, except its own sibling, comes with.

₹13K - ₹18K

This is the category where we see Blackberry OS5 and Symbian Anna fighting with Android. Even the old warhorse, A Nokia E72, still has enough on offer to hold its own in this category. We always love the underdog, don't we? Let's see how this lot fares.



Sony Ericsson Xperia Mini Pro

Features, build and usability: In this category, the touchscreen + QWERTY phones outnumber the touchscreen only ones 2:1. First through the door is the BlackBerry Curve 3G. While we like its form factor, the build quality isn't impressive. It's quite plasticky and the optical trackpad and keys around it tend to buckle.

The Nokia E72 does a lot better, with its solid yet sleek build. It's been around for a while, yet the build quality is good enough to compete with